Testing Relic Mechanics



Background:

About Slay the Spire 2(STS2):

Slay the Spire 2 is a highly anticipated roguelike deck-building game developed by Mega Crit and released in Early Access in March 2026. Building on the massive success of its 2019 predecessor, it combines deep strategic card combat with procedurally generated paths.

Players select one of five characters—three returning favorites (The Ironclad, The Silent, and The Defect) and two brand new additions (The Necrobinder and The Regent). Each character has a unique starting deck and a specific pool of cards to draft from. The core gameplay loop involves navigating multiple acts of a randomly generated Spire. Along the way, players face tactical turn-based battles where enemy intents are fully telegraphed, allowing for precise decision-making.

Between combats, players encounter "? events," visit merchants to buy cards, potions, relics or to remove cards, and rest at campfires to heal or upgrade their cards. A major new feature in the sequel is a cooperative mode that supports up to four players working together, modifying how combat and character abilities interact.

What are Relics in Slay the Spire 2:

In the Slay the Spire universe, Relics are crucial items for players. They provide permanent, passive bonuses, penalties or both, for the duration of a run. Once obtained, they

can only be in certain rare events, and their effects shape a player's long-term strategy and deck building.

How Relics are Obtained:

Relics are primarily earned by defeating Elite enemies and opening treasure chests. They can also be purchased from the Merchant using gold or acquired through specific, often risky, map events.

Relic Rarity Tiers:

There are over 250 Relics available, categorized by rarity:

- **Common:** Frequent drops providing consistent, foundational value.
- **Uncommon:** More specialized items that typically support specific deck archetypes.
- **Rare:** Highly powerful items capable of defining an entire run.
- **Ancient:** High-impact Relics that often fundamentally alter core mechanics, usually with a significant trade-off.
- **Shop & Event:** Relics exclusively found at Merchants or during map events, respectively.

First Test Suite: Relic Rules

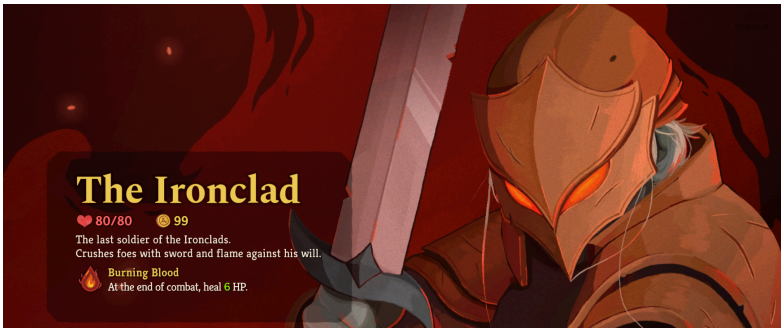
Reason for testing:

Some relics apply debuffs or buffs. We want to test if some of these effects are overruling others and how changing the order of the relics will change the order of the debuffs or buffs.

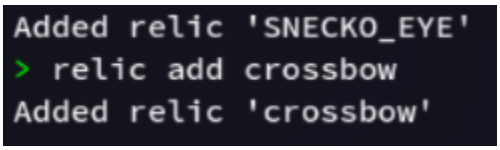
Test Case 1: Snecko Eye not overruling 1

Steps:

1. Start a singleplayer run and choose The Ironclad for character.



2. Apply the following commands
    a. relic add SNECKO_EYE
    b. relic add crossbow



3. Choose a combat room

Expected Result 1:

A card will be added and its value will be set to 0, other cards' values are randomized from 1 to 3.

Test Case 2: Snecko not overruling 2

Steps:

1. Start a singleplayer run and choose The Ironclad for character
2. Apply the following commands:
    a. relic add SNECKO_EYES
    b. relic add CHOICES_PARADOX
3. Choose a combate room

Expected Result 2:

Confused effects will be applied, but the chosen card will not have its value changed, as it wasn't drawn.

Test Case 3: Artifact Interaction - Marbles First

Steps:

1. Start a singleplayer run and choose The Ironclad for character.
2. Apply the following commands:
    a. relic add BAG_OF_MARBLES
    b. relic add RED_MASK
    c. fight CUBEX_CONSTRUCT_NORMAL

Expected Result 3:

Bag of Marbles triggers first, and its Vulnerable effect is negated by the Cubex Construct's Artifact. Red Mask triggers second, successfully applying the Weak debuff. The Cubex Construct starts the combat with Weak applied and 0 Artifact.

Test Case 4: Artifact Interaction - Red Mask First

Steps:

1. Start a singleplayer run and choose The Ironclad for character.
2. Apply the following commands:
    a. relic add RED_MASK
    b. relic add BAG_OF_MARBLES
    c. fight CUBEX_CONSTRUCT_NORMAL

Expected Result 4:

Red Mask triggers first, and its Weak effect is negated by the Cubex Construct's Artifact. Bag of Marbles triggers second, successfully applying the Vulnerable debuff. The Cubex Construct starts the combat with Vulnerable applied and 0 Artifact.